

Other Interview Methods

Estimated time needed: 2 minutes

Introduction

The majority of interviews are face-to-face on-site or in a virtual environment. However, depending on the role, you may encounter additional methods like whiteboard interviews and take-home interview assignments.

Objectives

After completing this reading, you will be able to:

- Describe the tips to be successful in a whiteboard interview
- Explain how you can manage take-home interview assignments

Whiteboard interviews

Companies use whiteboard interviews to see the interviewee solve coding problems on a whiteboard. However, whiteboard interviews may be used during a cybersecurity interview to gauge your technical ability, communication skills, and approach to problem-solving. For example, an interviewer might ask, *"Can you provide me with an illustration of a firewall implementation architecture?"*

Here are some tips to document an approach or solution on a whiteboard.

- **Practice whiteboarding techniques:** Practice mapping out key processes
- **Ask for permission before using the whiteboard:** If you use a whiteboard, ask for permission before you begin. There may be times during a technical interview when you can share your response using the whiteboard to combine a visual overview with your verbal response.
- **Learn mapping symbols:** Use an oval to show the process start and end, a rectangle for activities, and diamonds for decision points.
- **Take an organized approach:** Use the input-process-output method for each step.
- **Bring your whiteboard markers:** This action will also showcase your proactiveness to the interviewer. Don't let the lack of a whiteboard marker or markers without ink stop you.
- **Ensure you define any acronyms you may use:** Some interviewers may need to learn the definition of Packet Filtering (PF) Firewall.

Take-home interview assignments

You may need to complete a take-home assignment during the interview process. Take-home assignments are less stressful. You can work in your environment and use your favorite tools. Take-home assignments are often part of the HR or technical screening process to help screen for positions with many applicants. In addition, take-home interview assignments are generally timed and do not result in work the organization will use. They are evaluation tools.

If asked to complete a take-home assignment, ensure your time is worthwhile. If you accomplish the assignment, do your best.

An example of a take-home assignment:

Scenario	Examine the firewall implementation architecture and refer to the network diagram provided. Conduct a risk assessment and formulate a comprehensive mitigation plan based on the identified risks.
Duration	60 minutes



Skills Network